



The Registrar
NSW Civil & Administrative Tribunal
Guardianship Division
gd@ncat.nsw.gov.au

Public Guardian Report

NCAT case number: 2024/00324093

Date and time of hearing: 9/10/2025 at 10:00 AM

Hearing concerning:	Mr Barran Dodger
Address:	No fixed address, SA
Date of birth:	8/04/1973
Date of order:	16/10/2024
Functions:	Accommodation, Health Care, Legal Services, Services
Public Guardian ref:	2043514
Phone:	1300 076 694

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1 Recommendation

The Public Guardian believes Mr Dodger remains in need of a guardian. We recommend the order be renewed with the functions of Health Care, Legal Services and Services for a period of 12 months. We recommend the Accommodation function lapse.

2 Reasons

Mr Dodger is a 52-year-old male who is currently reported as homeless in South Australia. He was evicted from a private rental property in November 2024 due to nonpayment of rent. Since his eviction, Mr Dodger has been itinerant across regional New South Wales, Sydney, and, more recently, South Australia, accompanied by his dog, Crystal.

Mr Dodger has documented diagnoses of schizophrenia, ADHD, and a brain injury, and there is a reported history of illicit substance use. He has expressed significant distrust of government agencies, believing he is the target of a conspiracy, and maintains multiple social media accounts and a website outlining his perspectives. Mr Barran Dodger has publicly identified individuals he perceives as having wronged him, including making threats and allegations. Additionally, he has attended local NDIA offices and service providers, where he has made threats towards staff, resulting in police intervention and removal on several occasions.

Mr Dodger's parents, Mr Don and April McClean, have expressed concern for his welfare and maintain frequent contact with him, often providing financial support. In email communications received, Mr Dodger describes his parents as being complicit in the conspiracy against him.

On some occasions, Mr Dodger has independently secured accommodation and accessed services, sometimes by providing information to service providers that does not consistently align with his current NDIS funding. However, his ability to maintain these arrangements has been limited, often disrupted by aggressive behaviour necessitating police involvement.

Mr Dodger's finances are managed by NSW Trustee.

Accommodation and Authorise Others

The Public Guardian has not made any decisions regarding accommodation during the current order period. Mr. Dodger has an NDIS Support Coordinator who has provided him with multiple private rental accommodation options based on his known locations. However, Mr. Dodger has frequently declined to explore these options, often moving quickly from one area to another while living in his car with his dog, Crystal.

In or around June 2025, Mr. Dodger was reported to be in South Australia and no longer had his vehicle. He obtained accommodation through Thynk Care, which also provided him with NDIS supports. However, Mr. Dodger subsequently denied the service provider access

to the property when concerns were raised about damage to the property. Additionally, he declined supports from the provider and self-accessed additional NDIS support through the online service Mabel, without review by his Support Coordinator, Ms. Sukhi Tear, or consent from the Public Guardian, resulting in multiple unpaid invoices.

Mr. Dodger was evicted from the property with the assistance of SA Police and was subsequently transported to a hospital for a mental health assessment, where he was held for assessment and treatment under the mental health act. Mr. Dodger absconded from the hospital before the expiration of the mental health order. Police were unable to locate Mr. Dodger before the expiration date, and when found, he could not be returned to the hospital. Mr. Dodger is last reported to be homeless in South Australia.

Mr. Dodger has demonstrated that, despite the provision of support, he declines to accept it and has shown initiative in independently securing accommodation when he chooses to do so. He remains itinerant across several states and does not accept accommodation decisions made by the Public Guardian. Furthermore, the NSW Trustee requires that the Public Guardian make accommodation determinations before Mr. Dodger accepts any arrangement of his own choosing, which may affect his ability to obtain accommodation in a timely manner given his itinerant nature. Due to concerns related to paranoia, Mr. Dodger is reluctant to disclose details regarding his location or the supports he engages to the Public Guardian. Consequently, the Public Guardian requests that the accommodation function be discontinued.

Health Care

No health care decisions have been made during the current order period.

Mr Dodger has diagnoses of schizophrenia, ADHD, and a brain injury, and there is a reported history of substance use involving illicit drugs.

Mr Dodger was subject to a Community Treatment Order (CTO) requiring monthly medication until January 2025. The CTO was discharged by Campbelltown Community Mental Health Team at that time due to Mr Dodger no longer having a fixed address.

In August 2025, Mr Dodger was admitted to a mental health facility hospital in South Australia under an Involuntary Treatment Order following interaction with law enforcement after eviction from a property. Mr Dodger left the facility without notice and could not be located prior to the expiration of the treatment order.

Mr Dodger has declined participation in assessments aimed at determining his support needs.

Ongoing communication between health professionals and potential NDIS providers remains necessary regarding Mr Dodger's health. This communication helps advocate for appropriate funding and informs decisions about care requirements. Accordingly, it is recommended by the Public Guardian that the Health Care function continues.

Services

The Public Guardian has made several decisions regarding this function during the current Guardianship Order.

Mr Dodger has a Support Coordinator, Ms Sukhi Tear from DiversitasWA, who was appointed by the NDIA due to their location in Western Australia and previous incidents involving threats and aggressive behaviour towards NDIS supports and services.

Mr Dodger has often contacted NDIS support providers directly without notifying them about the appointment of Ms Tear. Frequently, providers only learn of Ms Tear's role or the involvement of the Public Guardian after initial contact, by which time communication difficulties have occurred.

Mr Dodger maintains that he is eligible for supported independent living (SIL) accommodation; however, this has been declined by the NDIA, and a review is currently pending before the Administrative Review Tribunal (ART).

Currently available information suggests Mr Dodger may not meet the eligibility requirements for SIL funding. Efforts to conduct updated assessments of his functional capacity have thus far been unsuccessful, as Mr Dodger has been unwilling to participate in assessments with engaged Occupational Therapist and Behaviour Support Practitioner.

There have been reports indicating that Mr Dodger has proposed arrangements to NDIS providers that could lead to inaccurate reporting of service hours in exchange for financial benefit, which may increase his vulnerability to unethical practices.

To ensure appropriate use of NDIS funding, continued access to suitable supports, and ongoing efforts to assess his functional capacity, the Public Guardian recommends maintaining the Services function.

Legal Services

One decision regarding Legal Services has been made during the current order period.

The Public Guardian consented to appoint Legal Aid to represent Mr Dodger in the Administrative Review Tribunal (ART) concerning his application for review related to Supported Independent Living funding. Legal Aid determined that Mr Dodger was unable to provide instructions. Initially, the Public Guardian declined to give instructions on behalf of Mr Dodger, as he had lodged the application himself and the Public Guardian could not act as a litigation supporter. Consequently, the Legal Aid application was declined.

The Public Guardian has since agreed to provide instructions on behalf of Mr Dodger regarding the appointment of a litigation supporter to give instructions in the ART matter and is awaiting a response from Legal Aid.

In addition, Mr Dodger has had multiple interactions with NSW and SA Police due to reports of verbally aggressive behaviour in the community. There are reports of outstanding warrants for his arrest in Victoria, though the Public Guardian does not have detailed information.

As decisions on Legal Services continue to be necessary, the Public Guardian recommends that the Legal Services function be maintained.

3 Decisions made under each function

Decisions made under the current order:

Function	Decision Date	Description	Status
Services for Barran Dodger	28/05/2025	The Public Guardian consents to NDIS service provider Arch Care Pty Ltd providing Mr Barran Dodger aka Richard Mclean with a personal support and transport service on 6th and 7th May 2025, to support them to engage independently in the community while in another state, in line with the needs and goals under their NDIS plan.	Approved
Services for Barran Dodger	31/03/2025	The Public Guardian consents to NDIS service provider ORS providing Mr Barran Dodger aka Richard Mclean with an occupational therapy service in line with the needs and goals under their NDIS plan.	Approved
Services for Barran Dodger	13/03/2025	The Public Guardian consents to NDIS service provider Connect to Blossom providing Mr Barran Dodger aka Mr Richard McClean with a Behaviour Intervention Support service in line with the needs and goals under their NDIS plan.	Approved
Legal Services for Barran Dodger	12/02/2025	The Public Guardian consents to the referral to Legal Aid and for Legal Aid to support Mr Barran Dodger (Richard McLean) through his	Approved

		pending legal proceedings.	
Services for Barran Dodger	22/01/2025	The Public Guardian consents to NDIS service provider SG Care providing Mr Baron Dodger aka Richard McClean with a daily living and community access service to support them at home and enable them to engage in the community in line with the needs and goals under their NDIS plan.	Approved
Services for Barran Dodger	17/01/2025	The Public Guardian consents to WA Plan Management Pty Ltd providing plan management supports and services to Mr Richard McLean, also known as Mr Barran Dodger. The Public Guardian understands that this will be funded through Mr McLean's NDIS plan.	Approved

4 NDIS participation

Mr Dodger has an active NDIS plan. He currently has the following services funded through his plan:

- NDIS Support Coordination – DiversitasWA
- Behaviour Intervention Support – Connect to Blossom (Pending Mr Dodger's engagement)
- Occupational Therapy – ORS (Pending Mr Dodger's engagement)

5 Guardian's availability for hearing

Duty Officer will participate by video for the hearing.

This report has been prepared by Duty Officer on 07/09/2025.

Supported by Regional Manager on 11/09/2025.

6 Guardian's availability for hearing
